Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Walking-bass chord melody, chromatic approaches, bass substitutions, and longer solo-guitar arrangements

LEVEL 82 OF 105 | 10 MODULES | 1,392 EVENTS

Level 82 strengthens the bass side of chord melody. The player now has to create a convincing low-register line, arrive on structural bass notes at the correct time, preserve a separate melody above it, and re-form the harmony without interrupting the pulse.

1. Bass is a melodic voice

Roots are only the beginning. The bass can use chord tones, scale steps, chromatic approaches, inversions, and pedal tones.

2. Beat 1 is structural

Approach notes may be adventurous, but the destination bass and chord must arrive cleanly at the harmonic landmark.

3. Independence before density

Bass, melody, and chord attacks are separated rhythmically before they are combined into full solo-guitar texture.

Bass-line construction hierarchy

```
1  destination root or inversion
2  chord tone on strong beat
3  diatonic connector
4  chromatic approach
5  enclosure / substitution


Reduction order when control fails:
full chord -> shell -> bass+melody -> bass only
```

Written workload

Module	Events
A	128
B	128
C	112
D	128
E	144
F	144
G	128
H	160
I	256
J	64
TOTAL	1392

Core-curriculum architecture

This is Level 82 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. Level 105 remains the hard stop for the universal sequence; advanced specializations begin only after the core is complete.

Practice rule: sing the bass destination before playing the approach. If the destination is not heard internally, chromatic motion becomes guesswork.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Reference: bass targets, approach logic, inversions, and slash-chord reading

DESTINATION FIRST - APPROACH SECOND

A SLASH CHORD NAMES THE UPPER HARMONY FIRST AND THE BASS NOTE SECOND

Device	Example	Bass function	Use
Root	Cmaj7	C	strongest identity
Third in bass	Cmaj7/E	E	smooth bass lift; first inversion
Fifth in bass	Cmaj7/G	G	expansion / pedal color
Seventh in bass	Cmaj7/B	B	stepwise motion toward Am
Diatonic approach	F-E-D	scale motion	connects targets without changing key
Chromatic approach	F-F#-G	leading motion	one half step into destination
Enclosure	F-F#-Ab-G	below/above	surrounds the destination

Four-beat walking-bass template

```
Beat 1  structural bass target
Beat 2  chord tone or scale step
Beat 3  direction-setting tone
Beat 4  approach into next bar
```

The melody may sustain across beats 2-4 while the bass walks. Do not force a new top note for every bass event.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module A - diatonic walking-bass chord melody, studies 1-2

2 STUDIES | 64 EVENTS

BUILD THE BASS ALONE, THEN ADD THE TOP LINE, THEN RESTORE THE CHORD BODY

Cmaj7 -> Am7

```
Bass:    C-B-A-G
Harmony: Cmaj7 | Cmaj7/B | Am7 | G7
Melody:  E-G-E-D
```

Pass 1: bass quarter notes. Pass 2: melody only. Pass 3: bass + melody. Pass 4: add guide tones on beats 1 and 3. Pass 5: full texture with the same bass timing.

Audit: the bass destination on the next beat 1 must sound stronger than every connecting note.

Dm7 -> G7

```
Bass:    D-E-F-F#-G
Harmony: Dm7 | Dm7/E | Dm7/F | D7/F# | G7
Melody:  F-A-C-B-G
```

Pass 1: bass quarter notes. Pass 2: melody only. Pass 3: bass + melody. Pass 4: add guide tones on beats 1 and 3. Pass 5: full texture with the same bass timing.

Audit: the bass destination on the next beat 1 must sound stronger than every connecting note.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module A - diatonic walking-bass chord melody, studies 3-4

2 STUDIES | 64 EVENTS

BUILD THE BASS ALONE, THEN ADD THE TOP LINE, THEN RESTORE THE CHORD BODY

Fmaj7 -> G7

```
Bass:    F-E-Eb-D-Db-C-B
Harmony: Fmaj7 | C/E | Cm/Eb | G7/D | Db7 | Cmaj7 | G7/B
Melody:  A-G-G-F-F-E-D
```

Pass 1: bass quarter notes. Pass 2: melody only. Pass 3: bass + melody. Pass 4: add guide tones on beats 1 and 3. Pass 5: full texture with the same bass timing.

Audit: the bass destination on the next beat 1 must sound stronger than every connecting note.

Cmaj7 turnaround

```
Bass:    C-E-F-F#-G-Ab-A-Bb-B-C
Harmony: Cmaj7 | C/E | F | F#dim7 | G7 | Ab7 | A7 | Bb7 | Bdim7 | Cmaj7
Melody:  E-E-F-F#-G-Ab-A-Bb-B-C
```

Pass 1: bass quarter notes. Pass 2: melody only. Pass 3: bass + melody. Pass 4: add guide tones on beats 1 and 3. Pass 5: full texture with the same bass timing.

Audit: the bass destination on the next beat 1 must sound stronger than every connecting note.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module B - chromatic approach bass lines, studies 1-4

4 STUDIES | 64 EVENTS

CHROMATIC NOTES ARE VALID ONLY IF THE DESTINATION BASS ARRIVES ON TIME

Approach C

```
Bass:   G-Gb-F-E-Eb-D-Db-C
Target Cmaj7
```

land on C at beat 1. First play with no upper harmony; then sustain one guide tone above the bass route.

Approach D

```
Bass:   A-Ab-G-Gb-F-E-Eb-D
Target Dm7
```

land on D at beat 1. First play with no upper harmony; then sustain one guide tone above the bass route.

Approach E

```
Bass:   B-Bb-A-Ab-G-Gb-F-E
Target Em7 / E7
```

choose G or G# in upper voice. First play with no upper harmony; then sustain one guide tone above the bass route.

Approach F

```
Bass:   C-B-Bb-A-Ab-G-Gb-F
Target Fmaj7
```

melody may hold A or E. First play with no upper harmony; then sustain one guide tone above the bass route.

Chromatic limit: use one approach device per destination until the line remains singable. More chromatic notes are not automatically more sophisticated.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module B - chromatic approach bass lines, studies 5-8

4 STUDIES | 64 EVENTS

CHROMATIC NOTES ARE VALID ONLY IF THE DESTINATION BASS ARRIVES ON TIME

Approach G

```
Bass:   D-Db-C-B-Bb-A-Ab-G
Target G7
```

target B in upper voice. First play with no upper harmony; then sustain one guide tone above the bass route.

Approach A

```
Bass:   E-Eb-D-Db-C-B-Bb-A
Target Am7
```

target C or E in melody. First play with no upper harmony; then sustain one guide tone above the bass route.

Enclose G

```
Bass:   F-F#-Ab-G
Target G7
```

chromatic lower/upper enclosure. First play with no upper harmony; then sustain one guide tone above the bass route.

Enclose A

```
Bass:   G-G#-Bb-A
Target Am7
```

G# works as leading approach, not chord quality. First play with no upper harmony; then sustain one guide tone above the bass route.

Chromatic limit: use one approach device per destination until the line remains singable. More chromatic notes are not automatically more sophisticated.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module C - bass substitutions, inversions, and slash-chord function

10 CELLS | 112 EVENTS

CHANGE THE BASS WITHOUT LOSING THE UPPER-CHORD IDENTITY

Type	Harmony	Bass	Purpose
Root -> 3rd bass	Cmaj7 -> Cmaj7/E	C -> E	same harmony, brighter bass lift
Root -> 5th bass	Cmaj7 -> Cmaj7/G	C -> G	pedal/expansion color
Root -> 7th bass	Cmaj7 -> Cmaj7/B	C -> B	descending step toward Am
Minor 3rd bass	Am7 -> Am7/C	A -> C	places b3 in bass
Minor 5th bass	Am7 -> Am7/E	A -> E	opens space under melody
Dominant 3rd bass	G7 -> G7/B	G -> B	strong pull toward C
Dominant b7 bass	G7 -> G7/F	G -> F	sets up E in Cmaj7
Predominant inversion	Dm7 -> Dm7/F	D -> F	smooth bass toward G or E
Pedal slash	Dm7/C -> G7/C	C -> C	bass pedal, upper harmony changes

Verification: play the upper chord without bass, then add the substituted bass. If the upper quality disappears, reduce the voicing and restore the third and seventh before adding extensions.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module D - bass-to-chord independence patterns

8 PATTERNS | 128 EVENTS

THE BASS AND CHORD BODY MAY SHARE HARMONY WITHOUT SHARING THE SAME ATTACK

Pattern	Instruction	Grid / cue
Quarter bass / offbeat chord	B on 1, chord on & of 2 and & of 4	P--- --C- P--- --C-
Walking quarters / held melody	bass on 1 2 3 4; melody sustains whole bar	B-B-B-B | M~~~
Bass eighths / chord quarters	bass 1-&-2-&; chord on 3 and 4	BBBB C--- C---
Syncopated melody / steady bass	bass quarters; melody on & of 1, a of 2, & of 4	keep bass mechanically even
Bass anticipation	approach destination on & of 4	old chord remains until approach note
Chord anticipation	new upper chord on & of 4; bass lands beat 1	separate harmonic and bass arrival
Two-beat bass fill	beats 3-4 bass walk; melody rests	re-form chord before next beat 1

Practice each pattern on Cmaj7, Am7, Dm7, and G7. First mute the strings and perform only the right-hand rhythm. Add bass notes second and chord tones last.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module E - major ii-V-I walking-bass studies 1-3

3 KEYS | 72 EVENTS

BASS MOTION CONNECTS THE HARMONY; GUIDE-TONE MELODY STATES THE FUNCTION

C major

```
Harmony: Dm7 | G7 | Cmaj7 | Cmaj7
Bass:    D-E-F-F# | G-Ab-A-B | C-B-A-G | C---
Top line: F-F-E-E
```

Play one guide tone per bar first. Then sustain or repeat it while the bass completes the printed walking route.

G major

```
Harmony: Am7 | D7 | Gmaj7 | Gmaj7
Bass:    A-B-C-C# | D-E-F-F# | G-F#-E-D | G---
Top line: C-C-B-B
```

Play one guide tone per bar first. Then sustain or repeat it while the bass completes the printed walking route.

D major

```
Harmony: Em7 | A7 | Dmaj7 | Dmaj7
Bass:    E-F#-G-G# | A-B-C-C# | D-C#-B-A | D---
Top line: G-G-F#-F#
```

Play one guide tone per bar first. Then sustain or repeat it while the bass completes the printed walking route.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module E - major ii-V-I walking-bass studies 4-6

3 KEYS | 72 EVENTS

BASS MOTION CONNECTS THE HARMONY; GUIDE-TONE MELODY STATES THE FUNCTION

A major

```
Harmony: Bm7 | E7 | Amaj7 | Amaj7
Bass:    B-C#-D-D# | E-F#-G-G# | A-G#-F#-E | A---
Top line: D-D-C#-C#
```

Play one guide tone per bar first. Then sustain or repeat it while the bass completes the printed walking route.

F major

```
Harmony: Gm7 | C7 | Fmaj7 | Fmaj7
Bass:    G-A-Bb-B | C-D-Eb-E | F-E-D-C | F---
Top line: Bb-Bb-A-A
```

Play one guide tone per bar first. Then sustain or repeat it while the bass completes the printed walking route.

E major

```
Harmony: F#m7 | B7 | Emaj7 | Emaj7
Bass:    F#-G#-A-A# | B-C#-D-D# | E-D#-C#-B | E---
Top line: A-A-G#-G#
```

Play one guide tone per bar first. Then sustain or repeat it while the bass completes the printed walking route.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module F - minor iiø-V-i walking-bass studies 1-3

3 KEYS | 72 EVENTS

PRESERVE THE FLAT FIFTH OF iiø AND THE MAJOR THIRD OF V7

A minor

```
Harmony: Bm7b5 | E7 | Am7 | Am7
Bass:    B-C-D-D# | E-F-G-G# | A-G-F-E | A---
Top line: D-D-C-C
```

The bass may chromatically approach V, but the upper line must still expose the dominant third before resolving into the minor tonic.

E minor

```
Harmony: F#m7b5 | B7 | Em7 | Em7
Bass:    F#-G-A-A# | B-C-D-D# | E-D-C-B | E---
Top line: A-A-G-G
```

The bass may chromatically approach V, but the upper line must still expose the dominant third before resolving into the minor tonic.

B minor

```
Harmony: C#m7b5 | F#7 | Bm7 | Bm7
Bass:    C#-D-E-E# | F#-G-A-A# | B-A-G-F# | B---
Top line: E-E-D-D
```

The bass may chromatically approach V, but the upper line must still expose the dominant third before resolving into the minor tonic.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module F - minor iiø-V-i walking-bass studies 4-6

3 KEYS | 72 EVENTS

PRESERVE THE FLAT FIFTH OF iiø AND THE MAJOR THIRD OF V7

D minor

```
Harmony: Em7b5 | A7 | Dm7 | Dm7
Bass:    E-F-G-G# | A-Bb-B-C# | D-C-Bb-A | D---
Top line: G-G-F-F
```

The bass may chromatically approach V, but the upper line must still expose the dominant third before resolving into the minor tonic.

F# minor

```
Harmony: G#m7b5 | C#7 | F#m7 | F#m7
Bass:    G#-A-B-B# | C#-D-E-E# | F#-E-D-C# | F#---
Top line: B-B-A-A
```

The bass may chromatically approach V, but the upper line must still expose the dominant third before resolving into the minor tonic.

C# minor

```
Harmony: D#m7b5 | G#7 | C#m7 | C#m7
Bass:    D#-E-F#-F## | G#-A-B-B# | C#-B-A-G# | C#---
Top line: F#-F#-E-E
```

The bass may chromatically approach V, but the upper line must still expose the dominant third before resolving into the minor tonic.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module G - melody over walking bass, key transfers 1-3

3 KEYS | 64 EVENTS

KEEP THE MELODY CONTOUR RECOGNIZABLE WHILE THE BASS ROUTE CHANGES KEY

C major

```
Melody: E-G-A-G-F-E-D-C
bass: C-B-A-G-F-E-D-G-C
Harmony: Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7-C
```

Sing both outer voices separately. Then play bass + melody with no inner chord tones. Add shells only after the two lines remain independent.

G major

```
Melody: B-D-E-D-C-B-A-G
bass: G-F#-E-D-C-B-A-D-G
Harmony: Gmaj7-Em7-Am7-D7-G
```

Sing both outer voices separately. Then play bass + melody with no inner chord tones. Add shells only after the two lines remain independent.

D major

```
Melody: F#-A-B-A-G-F#-E-D
bass: D-C#-B-A-G-F#-E-A-D
Harmony: Dmaj7-Bm7-Em7-A7-D
```

Sing both outer voices separately. Then play bass + melody with no inner chord tones. Add shells only after the two lines remain independent.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module G - melody over walking bass, key transfers 4-6

3 KEYS | 64 EVENTS

KEEP THE MELODY CONTOUR RECOGNIZABLE WHILE THE BASS ROUTE CHANGES KEY

A minor

```
Melody: C-E-F-E-D-C-B-A
bass: A-G-F-E-D-C-B-E-A
Harmony: Am7-Fmaj7-Dm7-E7-Am
```

Sing both outer voices separately. Then play bass + melody with no inner chord tones. Add shells only after the two lines remain independent.

E minor

```
Melody: G-B-C-B-A-G-F#-E
bass: E-D-C-B-A-G-F#-B-E
Harmony: Em7-Cmaj7-Am7-B7-Em
```

Sing both outer voices separately. Then play bass + melody with no inner chord tones. Add shells only after the two lines remain independent.

D minor

```
Melody: F-A-Bb-A-G-F-E-D
bass: D-C-Bb-A-G-F-E-A-D
Harmony: Dm7-Bbmaj7-Gm7-A7-Dm
```

Sing both outer voices separately. Then play bass + melody with no inner chord tones. Add shells only after the two lines remain independent.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module H - arrangement 1 - c major walking ballad

16 BARS | 80 EVENTS

ONE STRUCTURAL BASS NOTE AND ONE STRUCTURAL MELODY TARGET PER BAR

Bar	Chord	Bass	Melody	Function
1	Cmaj7	C	E	tonic
2	Cmaj7/B	B	G	walking bass
3	Am7	A	C	relative minor
4	G7	G	B	dominant
5	Fmaj7	F	A	predominant
6	F#dim7	F#	A	passing diminished
7	G7	G	B	dominant
8	Cmaj7	C	E	cadence
9	Am7	A	E	minor area
10	Am7/G	G	E	descending bass
11	Fmaj7	F	E	major seventh top
12	E7	E	G#	secondary dominant
13	Am7	A	C	arrival
14	Dm7	D	F	predominant
15	G7	G	B	dominant

Performance ladder: bass only -> melody only -> outer voices -> add guide tones -> full chord melody. Do not add a bass fill if it prevents the next chord from forming on time.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module H - arrangement 2 - a minor bass-led ballad

16 BARS | 80 EVENTS

ONE STRUCTURAL BASS NOTE AND ONE STRUCTURAL MELODY TARGET PER BAR

Bar	Chord	Bass	Melody	Function
1	Am7	A	C	tonic
2	Am7/G	G	E	descending bass
3	Fmaj7	F	A	VI
4	E7	E	G#	V7
5	Am7	A	C	return
6	Cmaj7/G	G	E	relative-major color
7	Dm7/F	F	A	predominant inversion
8	E7	E	G#	dominant
9	Bm7b5	B	D	iiø
10	E7/B	B	G#	dominant inversion
11	Am7/C	C	E	tonic inversion
12	Dm7	D	F	predominant
13	E7	E	G#	dominant
14	G#dim7	G#	B	leading diminished
15	AmMaj7	A	G#	minor-major tonic

Performance ladder: bass only -> melody only -> outer voices -> add guide tones -> full chord melody. Do not add a bass fill if it prevents the next chord from forming on time.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module I - thirty-two-bar solo-guitar capstone, bars 1-16

C MAJOR HALF | 128 EVENTS

WALKING BASS, PASSING DIMINISHED, SLASH CHORDS, AND CLEAR TOP-LINE TARGETS

Bar	Chord	Bass	Melody	Job
1	Cmaj7	C	E	tonic
2	Cmaj7/B	B	G	walking bass
3	Am7	A	C	relative minor
4	G7	G	B	dominant
5	Fmaj7	F	A	predominant
6	F#dim7	F#	A	passing diminished
7	G7	G	B	dominant
8	Cmaj7	C	E	cadence
9	Am7	A	E	minor area
10	Am7/G	G	E	descending bass
11	Fmaj7	F	E	major seventh top
12	E7	E	G#	secondary dominant
13	Am7	A	C	arrival
14	Dm7	D	F	predominant
15	G7	G	B	dominant

Bars 1-8 establish diatonic walking bass. Bars 9-16 add pedal melody, secondary-dominant color, and a stronger cadence into the second half.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module I - thirty-two-bar solo-guitar capstone, bars 17-32

A MINOR HALF | 128 EVENTS

MINOR CADENCE, LEADING-TONE BASS, AND TONIC-COLOR ENDING

Bar	Chord	Bass	Melody	Job
1	Am7	A	C	tonic
2	Am7/G	G	E	descending bass
3	Fmaj7	F	A	VI
4	E7	E	G#	V7
5	Am7	A	C	return
6	Cmaj7/G	G	E	relative-major color
7	Dm7/F	F	A	predominant inversion
8	E7	E	G#	dominant
9	Bm7b5	B	D	iiø
10	E7/B	B	G#	dominant inversion
11	Am7/C	C	E	tonic inversion
12	Dm7	D	F	predominant
13	E7	E	G#	dominant
14	G#dim7	G#	B	leading diminished
15	AmMaj7	A	G#	minor-major tonic

End the capstone on Am6, not with another turnaround. F# is a tonic color here; the melody must still make A minor unmistakable.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Module J - recovery, reduction, and no-restart repair

8 FAILURE MODES | 64 EVENTS

RECOVER THE BASS DESTINATION FIRST, THEN REBUILD THE CHORD-MELODY TEXTURE

Failure	Immediate repair	Restore
Bass misses beat 1	play root only next bar	restore walk one beat later
Melody disappears	remove one inner voice	keep bass + melody only
Chromatic approach sounds random	state destination root first	use only one approach note
Slash chord loses identity	play upper chord separately	re-add substituted bass
Bass and chord attack collide	separate them by one eighth note	recombine at slow tempo
Walking line outruns harmony	reduce to quarter-note roots	restore approach on beat 4
Hand cannot re-form chord	end walk one beat early	land destination shape cleanly

No-restart drill

Intentionally miss one bass approach in every eight-bar run. Continue with roots only until the next cadence, then restore the walking line. The recovery is part of the exercise, not an interruption of it.

Guitar Exercises - Section XI, Level 82

Level 82 mastery gate, practice progression, and log

NEXT: MELODY HARMONIZATION + SUBSTITUTION

ADVANCE ONLY WHEN BASS MOTION SUPPORTS THE ARRANGEMENT INSTEAD OF COMPETING WITH IT

Ten-phase practice progression

- [ ] 1. Root destinations
- [ ] 2. Diatonic walking lines
- [ ] 3. Chromatic approaches
- [ ] 4. Slash-chord bass substitutions
- [ ] 5. Bass/chord independence
- [ ] 6. Major ii-V-I routes
- [ ] 7. Minor iiø-V-i routes
- [ ] 8. Key-transfer outer voices
- [ ] 9. Two 16-bar arrangements
- [ ] 10. 32-bar capstone

Mastery standard

- [ ] Bass lands on destination beat 1
- [ ] Melody remains highest and audible
- [ ] Approach notes do not change chord identity
- [ ] Slash chords retain upper quality
- [ ] No collision between bass and chord attacks
- [ ] Major/minor cadences remain functional
- [ ] 32-bar form completed without restart

Passing score

Score 0-2 in eight categories: bass timing, bass-note choice, melody clarity, chord quality, independence, voice leading, form/pulse, and recovery. Pass at 14/16 or better on two separate days, with no zero in bass timing, melody clarity, form/pulse, or recovery.

Hard stop remains Level 105. Level 83 continues Section XI with melody harmonization, chord substitutions, reharmonization choices, and preserving a fixed top line across changing harmony.

Practice log

Date	Focus	Tempo	Bass clean?	Melody clear?	Weak transition	Next target